Klaim UK: Go-To-Market Strategy & Commercial Model

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1. Executive Summary

Klaim is the UK's first performance-based restaurant discovery app, built entirely on open banking infrastructure. It solves a fundamental inefficiency in the £101 billion UK eating out market [1]: restaurants spend over £3 billion annually on social media marketing without any ability to track return on investment (ROI) to physical visits [2]. Simultaneously, Gen Z consumers are dining out more frequently but are fatigued by traditional points-based loyalty schemes and discount vouchers that carry social stigma [3].

By leveraging the UK's mature open banking ecosystem (which reached 16.5 million users by late 2025 [4]), Klaim connects the digital impression directly to the physical transaction. Restaurants only pay when a verified customer walks through the door and pays with their linked card. Consumers receive real cash directly into their bank accounts.

This strategy paper outlines the commercial model, market positioning, competitive landscape (including the recent UK entry of EatClub), and a detailed 4-year financial roadmap. The strategy begins with a bootstrapped launch in January 2027 funded by a £30,000 Friends & Family round, with pre-launch social media advertising beginning in December 2026. This leads to a £750K pre-seed raise in January 2028.

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2. The Problem & Solution

The Restaurant Problem: The Attribution Black Hole

In 2026, 84% of UK restaurant operators allocate the majority of their marketing budget to social media [2]. However, there is zero native attribution from an Instagram or TikTok impression to a physical restaurant visit. Restaurants are effectively flying blind, spending an average of £30 to £80 to acquire a single customer without knowing which campaigns actually drove footfall.

Furthermore, traditional discount apps (such as Tastecard or EatClub) are actively avoided by premium and mid-market restaurants for customer acquisition. Academic research confirms that voucher use adversely affects brand perception and long-term loyalty [5]. These platforms also require complex point-of-sale (POS) integrations or proprietary digital cards, creating friction for staff at checkout.

The Consumer Problem: Broken Discovery and Fake Rewards

Gen Z's relationship with dining out is fundamentally different from previous generations. In 2026, 34% of UK consumers dine out three or more times per month, with Gen Z frequency rising rapidly [2]. While 73% of Gen Z use social media to find restaurants, the algorithms often trap them in echo chambers, showing the same viral spots repeatedly [6].

When it comes to rewards, this demographic rejects traditional loyalty. Points expire, vouchers are awkward to present at checkout, and loyalty stamps feel like a chore. They demand instant, transparent, real-money rewards. Furthermore, dining is inherently social, yet existing rewards apps are entirely solo experiences with no mechanism to coordinate with friends or share discoveries.

The Klaim Solution

Klaim solves both sides of the marketplace through a card-linked, gamified "drop" mechanic:

1. **Unwrap the Drop:** Every Monday and Friday, users receive personalised cashback offers to curated restaurants.
2. **Pay Normally:** Users visit the restaurant and pay with their linked bank card. There are no QR codes, no vouchers, and no staff interaction required.
3. **Instant Cash:** Open banking detects the transaction, and the cashback is transferred directly to the user's bank account within minutes.

For restaurants, Klaim is a zero-risk acquisition channel requiring no POS integration. For consumers, it is a frictionless way to discover new venues and earn real cash.

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3. Market Sizing & Dynamics

The UK eating out market is projected to reach £101 billion by the end of 2026 [1]. Within this, the full-service restaurant sector is valued at approximately £35.7 billion [7].

Klaim's initial focus is exclusively on London, which represents the most concentrated and lucrative segment of the UK market. London generates 22.6% of all UK hospitality revenue and boasts an average spend per visit that is 32% higher than the national average [8]. With over 11,400 restaurants, London provides the necessary density to build a two-sided marketplace [9].

The timing for Klaim is optimal due to four converging tailwinds:

1. **Open Banking Maturity:** The UK is the global leader in open banking, with 41% of adults already using the technology [4]. The infrastructure for frictionless card-linking is now mainstream.

2. **Gen Z Dining Habits:** The target demographic is dining out more frequently and relying heavily on digital discovery, yet they are actively rejecting traditional brand loyalty programs in favour of tangible value [3].
3. **Model Validation:** The identical business model was proven at scale in the United States by claim.co, which was acquired by Wonder Group (Grubhub's parent company) in 2025 [10]. The UK currently has no direct equivalent combining real cash, gamification, and social features.
4. **Restaurant Urgency — Dine-in over Delivery:** Restaurants are actively pushing dine-in hard. Deliveroo and JustEat commissions have hit 30-35%, making third-party delivery an increasingly unsustainable channel for operators [13]. This has created an urgent need for a tool that drives verified dine-in visits with true attribution to spend — precisely the gap Klaim fills.

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4. Competitive Landscape

The UK market contains several players in the cashback and loyalty space, but none occupy Klaim's specific positioning.

Platform	Reward Type	Payment Mechanic	Gamification	Social Features	Primary B2B Value Prop
Klaim	**Real Cash**	**Any linked bank card**	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Customer Acquisition**
EatClub	30-50% Discount	Proprietary digital card	No	No	Capacity Management
Shuffle	Real Cash	Any linked bank card	Partial	No	Customer Acquisition
JamDoughnut	Real Cash	Gift card purchase	No	No	Customer Acquisition
Tastecard	2-for-1 Discount	Physical/digital card	No	No	Capacity Management

Table 1: Competitive Matrix (2026)

The EatClub Threat & Differentiation

EatClub, an Australian-founded platform, recently launched in the UK with over 1,300 venues and backing from Marco Pierre White. While they are a direct competitor for restaurant partnerships, their model is fundamentally different:

- **The Discount Problem:** EatClub relies on 30-50% discounts to fill empty tables. This attracts discount-seekers and damages brand equity for premium restaurants. Klaim's cashback is positioned as a marketing reward, not a discount.
- **The Friction Problem:** EatClub requires users to pay using a proprietary "EatClub digital card." Klaim uses open banking, allowing users to pay with any card they already own.
- **The Value Prop:** EatClub sells *capacity management* (filling off-peak tables). Klaim sells *performance marketing* (acquiring loyal customers who pay full price).

Shuffle Rewards is structurally similar to Klaim but operates primarily in Northern cities (Manchester, Liverpool) and lacks the gamified "drop" mechanic and social features (Drop Buddies, trading) that drive habitual engagement.

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5. Go-To-Market Strategy

Klaim's GTM strategy is built on four distinct acquisition channels, each designed to minimise cash spend while maximising reach. The model is deliberately structured so that the most expensive channel (paid social) is the smallest contributor in the early years.

Consumer Acquisition

PLG Referral Loop (£5 / £5 Cash Incentive). When an existing user refers a friend and that friend completes their first verified transaction, both parties receive £5 cash directly to their bank accounts. This £10 payout is funded directly from Klaim's marketing budget. While this represents a hard cash cost, it is a highly efficient acquisition channel: the total cost per referred user is £10.46 (including API processing fees), which is significantly lower than the £44 CPA on paid social channels. This mechanic is structurally identical to the referral loops that drove early viral growth for Monzo and Revolut, ensuring that marketing spend is directed to high-intent users who have already completed a verified transaction.

Restaurant Organic Channels. Every restaurant partner is provided with branded window stickers (with QR codes linking directly to the Klaim app store page) and a library of social media assets — pre-made Instagram and TikTok templates, caption copy, and posting schedules. At 300 venues, each with ~200 daily footfall and a 1% QR scan rate, this channel generates approximately 18,000 scans per month at a one-off design and print cost of under £1,000.

Combined with restaurant social posts reaching an estimated 18,000 impressions per month, this organic channel contributes meaningfully to downloads at near-zero marginal cost.

Paid Social (Meta, TikTok, Apple Search Ads). Deployed from Month 2 of the pre-seed year, paid social is the scaling channel rather than the launch channel. The UK blended CPI for a fintech/lifestyle app is approximately £5 per install, with a 13% install-to-active-user conversion rate, producing a paid CPA of ~£44. This channel's share of total acquisition grows from 10% in Year 1 to 60% in Year 4 as the marketing budget scales.

Influencer Marketplace (Q3/Q4 Year 2)

Klaim will launch a curated influencer marketplace within the merchant portal, connecting restaurant partners with food and lifestyle influencers through a small number of agency partnerships. The model is structured as a three-way value exchange: restaurants gain access to pre-vetted, London-based creators at preferential rates; influencers receive a qualified pipeline of paid restaurant briefs without agency commission; and Klaim receives organic social content featuring the app at zero cash cost.

The Platform Integration Model. Rather than building a proprietary influencer marketplace from scratch or managing individual agency relationships, Klaim will integrate with an established creator platform via API. **TRIBE** (tribegroup.co) is the recommended integration partner for the UK market. TRIBE is a Meta Business Partner and TikTok Marketing Partner with a strong UK food and lifestyle creator network and white-label API capabilities. Klaim surfaces TRIBE's creator database directly inside the Klaim merchant portal under the Klaim brand. The commercial pitch to TRIBE is straightforward: Klaim brings qualified restaurant clients to their platform; TRIBE provides the creator network and campaign infrastructure. **Kolsquare** is the recommended secondary partner for influencer data and analytics, given their European-first focus and B Corp certification.

The Exchange Mechanic. Influencers in the Klaim network do not pay a platform fee. In exchange, they agree to include a Klaim call-to-action in any post produced for a restaurant partner — a QR code, an app store link, or a mention of the cashback mechanic. The restaurant pays the influencer directly at a negotiated rate. Klaim facilitates the introduction and provides the compliance brief.

Phased Rollout:

- **Q3 Year 2 (Pilot):** Partner with one agency. Curate a closed network of 20–30 food and lifestyle micro-influencers (10K–100K followers, London-based, minimum 4% engagement rate). Run five pilot campaigns pairing a restaurant Klaim drop with an influencer post. Measure app downloads attributable to each post, conversion to active users, and restaurant satisfaction scores.

- **Q4 Year 2 (Soft Launch):** If the pilot validates the flywheel, open the influencer marketplace as an opt-in feature in the merchant portal. Restaurants browse creator profiles, request a collaboration, and the influencer includes a Klaim CTA. Klaim takes no facilitation fee at this stage.
- **Year 3 (Monetisation):** Once the marketplace achieves volume, introduce a 5–10% facilitation fee on influencer deal values, or a premium listing fee for creators seeking priority placement. This becomes a fifth revenue stream.

Compliance. Every influencer in the network must receive and acknowledge a one-page ASA compliance brief before posting. Under ASA guidelines, any post promoting a financial product — including cashback or bank-linking — must be clearly labelled as a paid promotion, even when the payment is in-kind. This is non-negotiable and is the responsibility of the GTM Lead 1 (Restaurant Retention) to enforce.

Restaurant Acquisition

AI-Automated Outreach. Rather than spending on paid social for B2B acquisition, Klaim deploys AI-powered outreach sequences via WhatsApp, email, LinkedIn, and direct messages. Tools such as Clay and Apollo enable one person to send 500 personalised, contextually relevant messages per week across all channels. Combined with Sean's existing network of premium London restaurant groups, this approach targets a B2B CAC of approximately £12.50 per brand — 4 to 16 times more capital-efficient than traditional B2B sales.

Restaurant Referral Programme. Any restaurant brand that refers another brand to Klaim receives three months of free access to the Premium Analytics tier (a £1,050 value). The condition is that the referred restaurant must launch campaigns worth over £1,000 in cashback value. The deferred revenue is recovered within six months through platform fees generated by the referred restaurant's campaigns. This B2B viral loop is designed to compound the restaurant supply side without requiring additional headcount.

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6. Commercial Model & Unit Economics

Klaim's commercial model is built on four distinct revenue streams that unlock progressively as the platform scales.

Stream 1: Embedded Transaction Fee (Year 1)

The core revenue engine. Restaurants pre-deposit a campaign budget. When a restaurant offers a £10 cashback reward, Klaim deducts a £1.50 embedded platform fee per verified transaction. The user sees and receives £8.50 net cashback.

- **Restaurant proposition:** “Your £10 budget = £8.50 to the user + £1.50 to Klaim.”
- **Unit Economics:** £1.50 fee minus £0.46 API processing cost (TrueLayer + GoCardless) = **£1.04 net revenue per transaction** (69.3% gross margin).

Stream 2: Analytics Subscription (Year 1)

A tiered monthly SaaS subscription billed **per brand** (averaging 10 locations per brand), offering deep insights into cohort analysis, repeat rates, and competitor benchmarking across all their venues.

- **Pricing:** £299/month (Insights) to £599/month (Pro).
- **Value:** Creates a highly compelling single-bill proposition for multi-site operators.

Stream 3: Premium Placements & Targeting (Year 2)

An opt-in upgrade for restaurant partners. In exchange for an increased embedded transaction fee of **£2.00** (vs £1.50 standard), restaurants receive featured placement in drops and advanced audience targeting (age, location, dining frequency).

- **Unit Economics:** £2.00 fee minus £0.46 API cost = **£1.54 net revenue per transaction** (77% gross margin).

Stream 4: Data Platform & Consultancy (Year 3)

Enterprise-grade dining intelligence reports, footfall analysis, and consumer spending patterns sold to commercial property management firms, hotel groups, and FMCG brands.

- **Pricing:** Large contract value, project-based fees (£15K-£50K) or annual data licences (£30K-£100K).

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6. Team & Organisational Structure

Klaim is built by a lean, operator-first founding team. The technology is already built, allowing all early capital to be deployed toward acquisition.

The Founding Team

Role	Person	Core Responsibilities
Co-Founder	Sean	Initial restaurant supply, product strategy, business operations, fundraising
Co-Founder	Marc	Diner acquisition strategy, business operations, product strategy, engineering support
Co-Founder, Engineering	Cengo	Product architecture, open banking integrations, app performance
Co-Founder, Engineering	Yunus	Product development, merchant portal, data pipeline
GTM Lead 1	[Name TBC]	Diner acquisition, community growth, restaurant co-marketing
GTM Lead 2	[Name TBC]	Restaurant onboarding, partner success, campaign coordination

Note: GTM Lead 1 and GTM Lead 2 work alongside the founding team in Year 1 at zero salary and zero equity, contributing to diner acquisition and restaurant onboarding. They transition to full salaried roles in Year 2.

Hiring Roadmap

- **2027 (Bootstrap):** No external hires beyond GTM Lead 1 and GTM Lead 2 (zero salary, zero equity).
- **2028 (Pre-Seed):** GTM Lead 1 and GTM Lead 2 transition to salaried roles (£40K/year each), joined by GTM Lead 3 (£40K/year) and an Experience Marketing Expert (£60K/year).
- **2029 (Seed):** Backend Engineer (UK), Backend Engineer (Turkey), 2x Partnership Executives, Head of Data & Analytics.
- **2030 (Series A):** Senior Engineer (UK), 2x Partnership Executives, VP Marketing, 2x City Launch Managers.

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7. Financial Projections & Funding Roadmap (2027–2030)

The financial strategy is built on a highly disciplined, four-phase capital plan.

Phase 1: Bootstrap (2027)

- **Capital:** £30,000 Friends & Family round. Structured as an Advance Subscription Agreement (ASA) to preserve SEIS eligibility. If a valuation cap is required, £1.5M to £2M is standard for a pre-revenue UK consumer app with built technology [14].
- **Strategy:** Pre-launch social media advertising begins in **December 2026** to build initial demand before the January 2027 go-live. Launch with 30 premium brands (300 venues). All founders and GTM leads take £0 salary for the entire year.
- **Execution:** The £30K budget is deployed toward pre-launch social ads, guerrilla marketing, restaurant co-promotion, and essential operations. Any profit achieved is recycled back into GTM (diner and restaurant acquisition).
- **Target:** Prove the concept and GTM formula at small scale in London. Reach Seed KPI gates by end of 2027.

Phase 2: Pre-Seed (January 2028)

- **Target:** £750K Raise (£3M - £4M Pre-money valuation).
- **Strategy:** Scale aggressively in London and test 1-3 new UK markets. Founders begin drawing salaries (£65K/year). The team expands to hire 2 stakeholders for GTM/restaurant retention and 1 experience marketing expert.
- **Target:** 15,000+ active users, 650 venues, £500K+ revenue.

Phase 3: Seed (January 2029)

- **Target:** £2.5M Raise (£8M - £12M Pre-money valuation).
- **Strategy:** Scale aggressively in major UK cities and test 1-2 Western European cities. Launch the enterprise Data Platform.
- **Target:** 68,000+ active users, 1,500 venues, £2.4M+ revenue.

Phase 4: Series A (January 2030)

- **Target:** £8M+ Raise (£30M - £45M Pre-money valuation).
- **Strategy:** Scale aggressively in major European cities.

Metric	2027 (Bootstrap)	2028 (Pre-Seed)	2029 (Seed)	2030 (Series A)
Total Revenue	£103K	£523K	£2.35M	£9.57M
Gross Profit	£76K	£394K	£1.79M	£7.38M
Gross Margin %	73.8%	75.3%	76.5%	77.1%
Total OPEX	(£52K)	(£840K)	(£4.33M)	(£14.72M)
EBITDA	£24K	(£446K)	(£2.53M)	(£7.33M)
Active Users (EoY)	3,500	23,665	157,718	635,708
Restaurant Venues	420	650	1,500	3,700
Closing Cash	£54K	£358K	£323K	£989K

Table 2: 4-Year P&L Summary. User numbers reflect realistic blended CAC of £8.50–£27 per active user, incorporating the PLG referral loop, restaurant organic channels, AI-automated outreach, and restaurant referral programme.

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8. SWOT Analysis & Failure Modes

A realistic assessment of Klaim's strategic position requires acknowledging where the model is most vulnerable.

Strengths

- **Zero POS Integration:** Removes the single biggest barrier to B2B sales in hospitality.
- **Founder Network:** Existing relationships with premium UK restaurant groups bypasses the typical B2B cold-start problem.
- **Capital Efficiency:** The technology is already built, and the founding team's willingness to bootstrap 2027 on zero salary ensures maximum capital deployment toward acquisition.

Weaknesses

- **Margin Sensitivity:** The model relies on open banking API costs remaining low. Any pricing changes by TrueLayer or GoCardless directly impact gross margins.

- **Capital Intensity of B2C:** Acquiring consumers in London is expensive. If organic viral loops (Drop Buddies) fail to take hold, CAC will drain the runway quickly.

Opportunities

- **The claim.co Precedent:** The US acquisition proves the exit potential and commercial viability of the exact mechanic Klaim is deploying.
- **Data Platform Upsell:** Transitioning from a pure transactional model to enterprise data sales significantly increases the valuation multiple at Series A.

Threats & Failure Modes

1. **The Two-Sided Marketplace Cold Start:**
    - *The Risk:* Users download the app but find no restaurants they like; restaurants sign up but see no footfall.
    - *The Mitigation:* Klaim must execute a **supply-led launch**. The founder network must be leveraged to secure 30 premium London brands *before* any consumer marketing begins. Supply must be artificially constrained to specific London zones (e.g., Soho, Shoreditch) to ensure density.
2. **Restaurant Churn Due to Low Volume:**
    - *The Risk:* Restaurants don't see enough Klaim users to justify keeping the dashboard active.
    - *The Mitigation:* The "Drop" mechanic allows Klaim to artificially direct demand. If a partner is seeing low volume, Klaim can boost their visibility in the next drop to deliver a sudden spike in footfall, proving the ROI.
3. **Open Banking Friction:**
    - *The Risk:* Consumers drop off during the bank-linking phase due to security concerns.
    - *The Mitigation:* Messaging must heavily lean on FCA regulation and bank-level security. The promise of "real cash" must be strong enough to overcome the initial friction of linking an account.

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9. Conclusion

Klaim is positioned to solve a £3 billion attribution problem for UK restaurants while giving Gen Z the frictionless, cash-based rewards they demand. By bootstrapping 2027 with a fully built product and a zero-salary founding team, Klaim eliminates technical execution risk and proves the commercial model before raising institutional capital. The path to a £10M+ Seed valuation in

2029 is clear, provided the team executes a disciplined, supply-led launch in January 2027 with an initial cohort of 30 premium brands.

References

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